LEVEL 7 ADVENTURE MODULE

DARK TOWER

THE SUNKEN TEMPLE OF SET

A DARK TOWER ADVENTURE

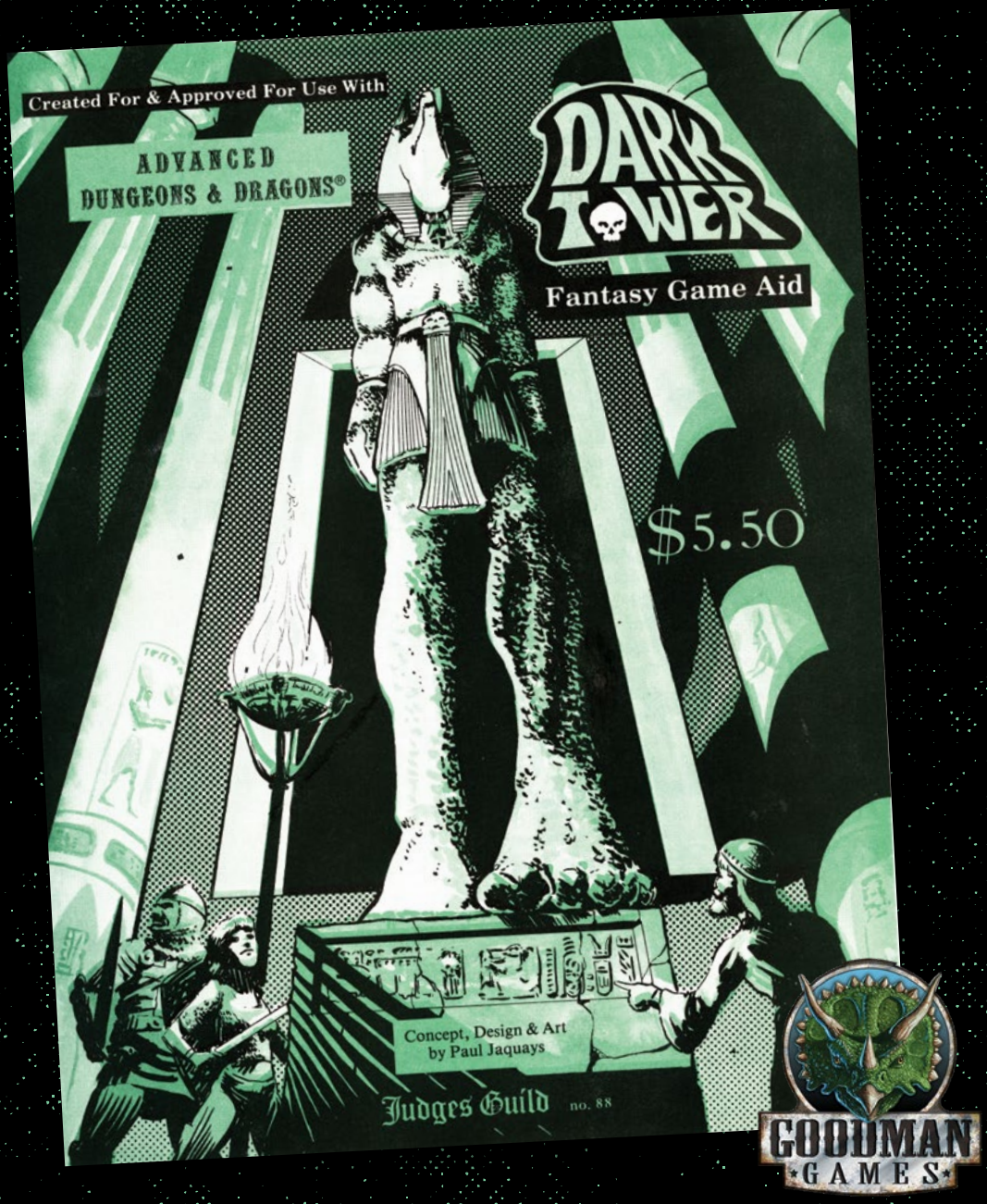
BY CHRIS DOYLE

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DARK TOWER

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THE SUNKEN TEMPLE OF SET

A DARK TOWER FIFTH EDITION
FANTASY ADVENTURE BY CHRIS DOYLE

BASED ON THE ADVENTURE **DARK TOWER**, ORIGINALLY CREATED BY JENNELL JAQUAYS

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THE SUNKEN TEMPLE OF SET

By Chris Doyle



The Sunken Temple of Set is an adventure designed for use with the fifth edition of the first fantasy roleplaying game. It is intended for four to six characters of 7th to 8th level. The adventure occurs in a barren, rocky, mountainous region bordering a sandy waste and has a distinctive Egyptian theme. This adventure can be used as a side adventure for a *Dark Tower* campaign (available from Goodman Games). If used as such, the adventure location is a box canyon in the Redmoon Pass to the east of the Village of Mitra's Fist. The adventure is also easy to place in the GM's own campaign. If the deity Set does not occur in the GM's campaign, he can substitute a similar evil serpentine deity.

BACKGROUND

In a concerted effort to spread discord and evil among the mortal races, the god Set sired many bastard offspring via its dalliances among them. The result was a jumble of divine and mortal traits, but all of his children were hideous snake, reptilian, and humanoid crossbreeds. Each was a unique, twisted fiend, as Set steeped his creations in chaotic sorcery. These he called his sons, and they were spread far and wide to disseminate their vile plots.

He had many sons, but only the four most powerful were his Chosen Sons. The rest, and most numerous, are called his Lesser Sons. All the Sons of Set share a spark of immortality. A Lesser Son always fights to the death, hoping to gain Set's favor, for if it's destroyed it reforms in one to two years. The Chosen Sons are more practical and often surround themselves with minions, preferring to eschew direct conflict. A slain Chosen Son of Set returns as a Lesser Son, and the most powerful and worthy Lesser Son ascends to the title of Chosen Son. This often results in the Lesser Sons taking matters into their own scaly appendages. Should a Lesser Son slay a Chosen Son, Set would have no choice but to elevate it to its rightful position as a Chosen Son. But failure curses a Lesser Son to 100 years of service to its brother.

A year ago, an ambitious Lesser Son named Makura desired to challenge Manahath, a Chosen Son of Set rumored to reside in the nearby Dark Tower of Set. But Makura never got the chance to challenge the Chosen Son. Set himself placed this Chosen Son as guardian and ally to a powerful Lich. Makura's undoing was a feigned

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alliance with another Lesser Son named Konah the Dissenter. Konah betrayed his brother with an arcane onslaught and sent him back to the Lower Planes to seethe in his failure.

But Makura's tale doesn't end there, as Set himself was intrigued by the brash powerplay. Following a year of banishment, when Makura was granted the right to walk again among the mortals, he awoke in a ruined temple not too far from the Dark Tower. The temple was dedicated to Sobek, the lesser crocodile god of destiny. Makura, with three crocodilian heads, took this as a favored sign from Set, and set about to rededicate this temple to his god, Set. Soon after, a werecrocodile high priest of Sobek arrived at the temple at the behest of his deity, but quickly pledged its service to the powerful Lesser Son. This dedication is but a ruse, as the priest has his own agenda, which includes reclaiming the ruined temple in the name of his god. Rynchus bides his time and plots to overthrow Makura.

ADVENTURE HOOKS

The werecrocodile priest Rynchus is trying to lure heroes to the sunken temple to confront his new "master". How the characters learn about the sunken temple is up to the GM, but here are a few suggestions:

- The characters begin as captives to a band of **soben** (see area 1). The party is told they are being taken to be fed to the temple's master. The soben are hopeful for a reward. Either the characters can escape in route (maybe they run amok of Soukhos in area 2 during the boat ride), or they could arrive at the temple still prisoners. In either case, the GM can develop a way for them to escape or allow them an audience with Rynchus to bargain for their freedom.
- Old Cornelius, a senile and befuddled priest of Mitra (see area V-1 in *Dark Tower*) has seen a clouded vision from his god. The vision reveals a partially sunken temple in a lake at the bottom of a box canyon with steep cliffs. The evil of Set holds sway over this ruined temple, and perhaps it as a clue to the mystery of the Village of Mitra's Fist. He beckons the party to investigate the temple with all haste and grants a worthy character a boon as encouragement. If the GM has *Dark Tower*, this is *Mitra's Favor*. Otherwise, it's a *spell scroll of raise dead*.
- Rynchus, through intermediary followers of the god Sobek, contacts the characters and offers a reward of gems if they investigate a ruined temple in the wilderness to the East of Mitra's Fist. He claims it was abandoned, but now it seems brigands or humanoids are using the haunted place as a base of operations. He hints the hallowed halls might still contain riches and divine magic from a bygone age.
- The characters learn that a lost Mitraic artifact, *Mitra's Bulwark*, is possibly hidden in a nearby ruined temple. The characters are encouraged by their benefactor to recover the relic for the purposes of reuniting it with other Mitraic artifacts in the fight against Set.

NEW WEAPONS

This adventure includes a few new weapons; the khopesh and mace-axe were commonly used in ancient Egyptian cultures while the macana has South and Central American origins.

Khopesh. A khopesh is a sickle-shaped blade derived from the battleaxe. Only the outer edge of the blade is sharpened. The center of the sickle blade is used to disarm an opponent's weapon or shield. On a successful hit, the wielder can decide to not inflict damage and instead force the target to drop its hand-held weapon or shield. The target does not drop the weapon if it can succeed on a Strength saving throw against a DC equal to 8 + wielder's Strength modifier + wielder's proficiency bonus if proficient in the khopesh.

Macana. A macana is a flat wooden sword-like paddle set with obsidian shards or serrated animal teeth. Shark or crocodile teeth are commonly used.

Mace-axe. A mace-axe is a metal- or stone-headed club with an axe blade set into the head. It's a two-handed weapon that inflicts both slashing and bludgeoning damage, designed to bash through mundane weapons and bronze armor.

Name	Cost	Damage	Weight	Properties
Khopesh	12 gp	1d8 slashing	3 lbs.	Special
Macana	10 gp	1d8 slashing	4 lbs.	-
Mace-axe	25 gp	1d6 slashing and 1d6 bludgeoning	6 lbs.	Heavy, two-handed

PART 1: THE CANYON LAKE

The sunken temple of Set is located in a flooded box canyon at the foot of Mount Bone-head about 1.5 miles southeast of the Village of Mitra's Fist. Since the river that exits the box canyon swiftly flows to the west through a ravine, it is easiest to approach from the higher elevation. This puts the characters at the west end of the box canyon looking down at the temple, partially submerged in a lake. Consult map 1 for an overview of this locale.

Makura was recently reincarnated by Set, and now resides in the sunken temple, bidding his time to strike back at his enemies. The powerful spawn of a god has not yet established regional effects of his evil taint. That said, perceptive characters notice a few unusual effects as they get within half a mile of the sunken temple. A profusion of mundane snakes and lizards gather near the canyon and may appear in a character's packs. Dark clouds and a cold wind create a sense of foreboding. The occasional influx of chaotic eldritch magic sours waterskins, bruises desert plants, and creates the sound of a serpent's hiss on the wind. None of these effects impact combat, but they serve to unnerve the players and provide atmosphere.

AREA 1 –THE ROPE BRIDGE

Travel through the broken rocky terrain has been slow at best as you meander along the top of a steep-sided ravine. Below, the bottom is occupied by the churning rapids of a swift moving river cutting through the barren landscape. A worn rope bridge spans the ravine at a narrow location. It appears sturdy as it sways in the cold breeze.

The denizens of the Sunken Temple installed this rope bridge to provide easier access to the paths that lead down into the box canyon (areas 3 and 4). Recently, Rynchus added guards to the bridge. These flunkies are under orders to prevent anyone from crossing, but really, Rynchus is punishing them for insubordination and displaying too much respect for Makura. Rynchus would like nothing more than these two brutes falling to the blades of the characters while at the same time giving the false impression this route is well guarded.

Rope Bridge. The bridge is composed of standard hemp rope intertwined to improve strength and resilience. Wooden planks form the bridge base, spaced one foot apart. The bridge is 75 feet long, securely tied to massive rocky outcrops. It would take about 10 minutes to untie the massive knotted rope at one end. Although it sways in the wind, crossing is simple and doesn't require skill checks for characters who cross at half speed. Characters who cross at regular speed must succeed on a DC 10 Dexterity (Acrobatics) check or trip and fall prone. The bridge can easily support 1,500 pounds of weight.

The bridge can be destroyed with weapon blows. A typical plank has an AC 14 and 5 hit points. The rope part of the bridge is AC 12, has 15 hit points, and is vulnerable to slashing damage, but resistance to bludgeoning and piercing damage. Severing one of the ropes causes the bridge to suddenly shift and tilt at a sharp angle. All on the bridge must make a successful DC 10 Dexterity saving throw or fall off the bridge. If a second rope is severed, the bridge collapses. Targets on a collapsing bridge that make a successful DC 17 Dexterity saving throw to hold onto the bridge as it slams into one of the ravine walls, taking 10 (3d6) bludgeoning damage. Climbing up a severed rope bridge requires a successful DC 10 Strength (Athletics) check.

The ravine is approximately 120 feet deep with a raging river. Falling into the ravine causes 28 (8d6) bludgeoning damage as the water somewhat cushions the fall. But the target is swept 30 (1d6 x 10) feet down stream at the end of each of their turns, taking an additional 3 (1d6) bludgeoning damage for each 10 feet of movement.

Guards. During the daylight hours, the bridge is guarded by a pair of **soben,** stationed on the northern side. These 10-foot tall bulky lizardfolk-like humanoids have thick scaled hides and crocodilian heads. Each hefts a massive khopesh (a hooked sword), carries a longbow slung over its back, and has a sword-like blade affixed to its crocodilian tail.

The soben address the characters in sibilant, halting Common, blocking passage across the bridge. They demand a toll of at least 200 gp to pass, but can be bargained down with a successful DC 15 Charisma (Intimidation) check. They do not respond to Persuasion, only dominance and threats. If the characters refuse, it comes to blows, but the soben flee (not across the bridge, however) if reduced to half hit points. Once one flees, the other follows suit.

The soben carry no treasure. One of them carries a bloody leather sack holding two haunches of camel meat—not just for snacking, this meat is used to appease the beast in area 2 when they use the boat to return to the temple.

They are armed with longbows to take down other prey to replenish their supply of fresh meat.

Developments. The soben are not trustworthy. If the characters pay the toll, they wait until targets are halfway across before they attack the ropes of the bridge with khopesh blows. If the soben flee from combat, they don't travel far, seeking to double back and sabotage the bridge while the characters cross.

SOBEN (2)

Large humanoid, lawful evil

AC: 14 (natural armor, breastplate)

Hit Points: 59 (7d10 + 21)

Speed: 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	10 (+0)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	5 (-3)

Damage Immunities: poisoned

Condition Immunities: frightened, poisoned

Skills: Athletics +7

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages: Common, Draconic

Challenge: 4 (1,100 XP)

Special Equipment: Each soben carries a holy symbol of Sobek.

Great Charge: If the soben moves at least 10 feet straight toward a target and then hits it with a shoulder slam attack on the same turn, the target takes an extra 9 (2d8) bludgeoning damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 13 Strength saving throw or be pushed 5 feet away and knocked prone.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The soben makes two attacks: one with its main weapon (or bite, if unarmed) and one with its shoulder slam or tail blade.

Khopesh: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 14 (2d8 + 5) slashing damage. The soben can forgo dealing damage to instead force the target to make a DC 15 Strength saving throw or drop its weapon or shield (soben's choice).

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 12 (2d6 + 5) piercing damage.

Shoulder Slam: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d6 + 5) bludgeoning damage.

Tail Blade: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (1d8 + 5) slashing damage.

This lizard-like humanoid is massive, with dark gray scales and a hunched back. The creature sports bulging muscles and lumbers forward on two thick legs, its heavy tail dragging behind. Its head resembles that of a crocodile.

AREA 2 – THE SACRED LAKE

When the characters get a good look at the box canyon from above, read the following:

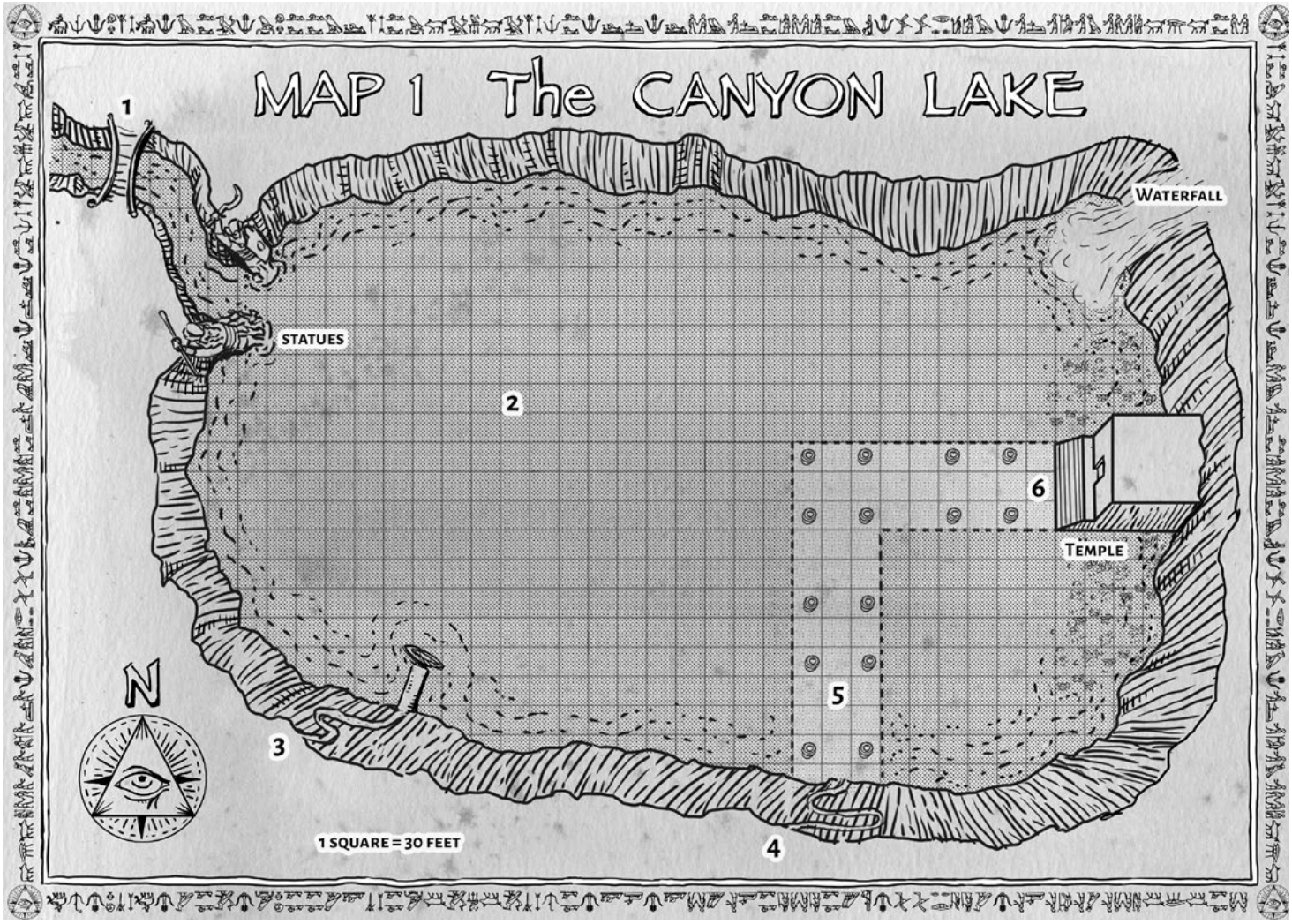
Standing at the edge overlooking a box canyon is a majestic site. The bottom of the box canyon holds a turbid lake, which drains through a ravine along the west side. The river and ravine are flanked by massive statues of crocodile-headed humanoids that nearly reach the top of the cliff-face. At the east end of the canyon, which stretches for hundreds of feet, a partially submerged stone temple is set into the wall of the cliff. Dense beds of flowering lotus bobbing at the water's surface flank the temple. To its north, a massive waterfall tumbles into the canyon from hundreds of feet above, agitating lake water and throwing mist into the air.

Along the southern edge of the canyon wall where the ridge is lowest, you spy a wooden dock that juts into the lake. Tied to the end of the dock is a reed boat.

The lake extends to the cliff-like edges of the box canyon. The lake is fed by a towering waterfall, which disturbs the bottom, creating muddy water, especially at the eastern end of the lake. The outlet is a ravine on the northwest side of the box canyon. The water depth slopes from 10 feet at the edges to a maximum depth of 20 feet (except for the Avenue of the Faithful—see area 5) along the north side.

Swimming in the mostly placid lake requires a successful DC 10 Strength (Athletics). The DC of this check increases to 15 as the swimmer gets to within 100 feet of the waterfalls. Failure indicates the swimmer is forced under and pushed 20 feet away from the falls.

Statues. A pair of 100-foot-tall statues are carved into the cliff face flanking the river outlet. Each depicts a muscled male human wearing scale mail, but with a crocodile head. The one to the left wears ceremonial robes and a tall headdress and proudly presents a staff aloft in an outstretched arm while holding a mace-axe in its off-hand. The other, clearly a warrior-type, has a smaller headdress, brandishes a khopesh up high, and braces a shield in the



other hand. The craftmanship of each of these is exquisite, although somewhat worn from erosion and the exposure to the elements.

The Guardian. The lake is inhabited by a giant crocodile sacred to the Sobek faith. Soukhos is a 20-foot-long aggressive crocodile that indiscriminately attacks those attempting to cross the lake to the temple—that is, unless an offering of fresh meat (at least 10 pounds) is presented or the "faithful" walk along the avenue between the pillars (see area 5). Soukhos spends most of its time during the day floating among the lotus beds at the east end of the lake. At night it pulls its massive bulk out of the water and rests on a few rocks along the northern shore of the lake.

Soukhos attacks swimmers using its stealth to gain a surprise attack. Due to the turbidity of the water, this Stealth check is at advantage. It also targets the reed boats (or any other floating structures) unless an offering of food is made. It can spend an action trying to capsize the boat, succeeding 10% of the time. Any targets in the boat caught unaware of Soukhos' capsize attempt must succeed on a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw or be tossed from the boat. If it fails to capsize the boat, it attacks the hull with its bite and tail slap, sinking the vessel once it's reduced to 0 hit points (see area 3).

Development. When the characters arrive at the lake, there is a 50% chance that Rynchus (see area 11) in crocodile form is lazily floating on the surface of the lake among the lotus pads to the north of the temple. He can be spotted with a passive Perception of 20 before he submerges. Most likely, he is the one who attracted the characters to the temple in the first place. Assuming they are in the reed boat or walking along the avenue of the faithful, when they get within 300 feet of the temple, he changes into his hybrid shape and casts *control water.* He chooses the flood effect as the water is not deep enough for the whirlpool effect. He commands the water to create a series of 20-foot-high waves (one each turn) to crash into the characters or boat. If they are in the boat, there is a 25% chance per wave of it capsizing. If they stand on the avenue of the faithful, a character must make a

successful DC 14 Strength check or be swept off the avenue and into deeper water where they become a viable target for Soukhos' wrath. Rynchus secretly attacks with the waves for 2-3 rounds, or until he is reduced to half hit points, before retreating.

SOUKHOS, SACRED GIANT CROCODILE

Huge beast, lawful evil

AC: 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 126 (12d12 + 48)

Speed: 30 ft., swim 50 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
23 (+6)	10 (+0)	18 (+4)	2 (-4)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)

Skills: Stealth +6, Perception +5

Senses: truesight 60 ft., passive Perception 15

Languages: —

Challenge: 6 (2,300 XP)

Hold Breath: Soukhos can hold its breath for 30 minutes.

Sacred Blessing: Soukhos gets advantage on all saving throws against spells and magical effects.

Special Equipment: Emerald set his in head (worth 1,000 gp), three gold teeth (each worth 50 gp), body pierced with three gold rings (worth 250 gp, 400 gp, and 600 gp).

ACTIONS

Multiattack: Soukhos makes one bite and one tail attack.

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 22 (3d10 + 6) piercing damage and the target is grappled (escape DC 17). Until this grapple ends, the target is restrained and the giant crocodile can't bite another target.

Tail: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 15 (2d8 + 6) bludgeoning damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 17 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

Death Roll (3/day): If Soukhos is grappling a target, it can perform a violent death roll. The grappled target takes 11 (1d10 +6) bludgeoning damage and 11 (1d10 +6) piercing damage and the target needs to make a successful DC 17 Constitution saving throw or become stunned until the end of its next turn.

AREA 3 – THE OBVIOUS WAY DOWN

If the characters walk along the southern ridge of the canyon, they come across an obvious trail winding its way to the lake's edge and a crude dock. A successful DC 15 Survival check reveals a few sets of humanoid footprints that continue past this route and proceed toward area 4.

The rocky trail is steep and meanders down to the water's edge. Despite a few slips and stumbles, soon you are at the lake's edge. Before you is a crude wooden dock, cobbled together with mismatched boards and secured with hemp rope. Securely tied to the end of the dock is a reed skiff.

Despite appearances, the dock is secure and durable. It juts out into the lake about 12 feet, and the water's depth quickly drops off. A successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check while examining the wooden structure reveals dried blood splotches on the planks.

Reed Skiff. The reed skiff is about 15 feet long and can fit six Medium-sized creatures comfortably (eight maximum). There is a 20-foot-long pole-paddle inside that can be used to pilot the craft. The skiff has an Armor Class of 11 and 60 hit points.

Developments. The sacred guardian (see area 2) attacks the skiff unless an offering of fresh meat is dropped into the water soon after departing the dock.





AREA 4 – THE HIDDEN PATH

If the southern ridge line is searched past the obvious trail (area 3), this concealed path can be located with a successful DC 17 Wisdom (Perception) check. If the tracks in area 3 were discovered, this check is made at advantage. If discovered, read the following:

After careful examination, it appears there is a route down the slope here. It picks its way through a maze of boulders and rocky outcroppings, but it seems safe. In a few minutes, you are at the edge of the lake. The water doesn't seem as deep here.

This hidden route leads to the Avenue of the Faithful (area 5). While trekking down the slope here, a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) reveals the tip of a stone column or pedestal just below the surface of the water, and then another, as indicated on map 1.

AREA 5 – AVENUE OF THE FAITHFUL

Hidden beneath the surface of the lake is an elevated fitted stone platform that leads out into the open water and then takes a 90 degree turn toward the temple steps. The "avenue" is just under 100 feet wide and the water here is only 4 feet deep. Walking along the avenue is considered difficult terrain.

Pedestals. The avenue is demarked by a series of 3-foot-high pedestals now 1 foot beneath the surface of the water. Affixed to the top of these stone columns are enchanted bronze braziers. If one is touched with a holy symbol dedicated to Sobek and the cantrip *sacred flame* is cast, the braziers ignite, as per *continual flame* (even underwater), but with a duration of eight hours.

Lotus Beds. Flanking the temple are dense beds of floating lotus full of vibrant purple flowers. A creature in a lotus bed gets advantage on all Stealth checks to hide.

Development. Soukhos, the sacred guardian in area 2, will not attack anyone "walking" along the avenue, but Rynchus may sweep the party off the path with his *control water* spell (see area 2).

PART 2: THE SUNKEN TEMPLE OF SET

The temple was constructed when the box canyon was dry. Then, by channeling divine magic, a high priest altered the course of a nearby river, rerouting it to spill into the canyon. Now, the temple is partially submerged and contains a fully flooded crypt.

The sunken temple was once dedicated to Sobek, the crocodile god of fertility and flowing water (such as mighty rivers). But now, with the arrival of Makura the temple has been rededicated to Set—although this doesn't sit well with his ally, the priest Rynchus.

GENERAL FEATURES

The sunken temple is depicted on map 2.

The Steps. Six stone steps are submerged in the lake, leading to a stone stage in front of the doors. The stage is covered with about 1 foot of water.

Illumination. Individual rooms describe the type of illumination in the chambers (if any).

Walls and Ceilings. The interior walls and ceiling are all worked stone. Climbing an interior wall requires a successful DC 15 Strength (Athletics) check. The ceiling heights vary by room description.

Flooding. Area 6 is covered with 1 foot of water. Areas 7 and 8 are completely underwater. The shaft at area 9 is partially underwater (30 feet), while areas 10 and 11 are dry.

Wandering Monsters. There are no wandering monsters in the temple, but two **soben** (see area 1) are currently out hunting. If the party tries to take a long rest in the temple, Rynchus summons them and sends them to evict the interlopers.

AREA 6 – THE TEMPLE OF SET

The massive stone doors blocking entry to area 6 are unlocked, but trapped with a *glyph of warding* (cast with a 5th level spell slot). If the door is opened without pressing Sobek's holy symbol onto its surface, the glyph releases a *wall of force* spell in area 6 (indicated by the dashed line between the last two pillars). The wall is 20 feet high and lasts for 10 minutes. The glyph can be detected with a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check. When the characters approach the temple doors, read the following:

Carved on the exterior of these two massive stone portals are a pair of crocodile-headed humanoids standing in the rapids of a river, joining hands under a blazing sun. Water from the lake laps up against the base of the door.

It takes an action and a successful DC 12 Strength (Athletics) check to open the doors. When opened, read the following:

When pulled open, the doors reveal an expansive chamber of worship about 80 feet wide and perhaps 50 feet deep. The floor is covered by 1 foot of murky water. The walls are painted with pictographs of crocodiles savagely attacking farmers, commoners and sailors. The beasts graphically tear apart swimmers, capsize reed boats, and burst from the shallows to surprise those on the banks.

Three sets of stone pillars, each engraved with different crocodile-hybrid beasts, reach to the ceiling 30 feet overhead. At the far end of the room is a giant-sized stone throne, 10 feet wide and double the height, its back carved into a water plume. Flanking the throne are a pair of statues that nearly reach the ceiling. Each depicts a powerful human figure with a crocodile head. Both are adorned with ornate stone breastplates, wear a ceremonial headpiece, and hold a crescent-shaped khopesh aloft.

This massive chamber was the central worship area to Sobek in the temple's heyday. It features a stone throne that the clergy could use to address the congregation magically while not actually in the chamber. The floor is covered with about 1 foot of cloudy water, but it's not deep enough to impede movement.

Pillars. Six carved stone pillars lead to the throne. Due to the carved design, these are easy to climb, requiring only a successful DC 10 Strength (Athletics) check. Each is attached to the ceiling, and thus can't be toppled. Each features a crocodile-hybrid creatures as part of the design. These include (letters refer to the map) the following:

A. Snakes and Serpents

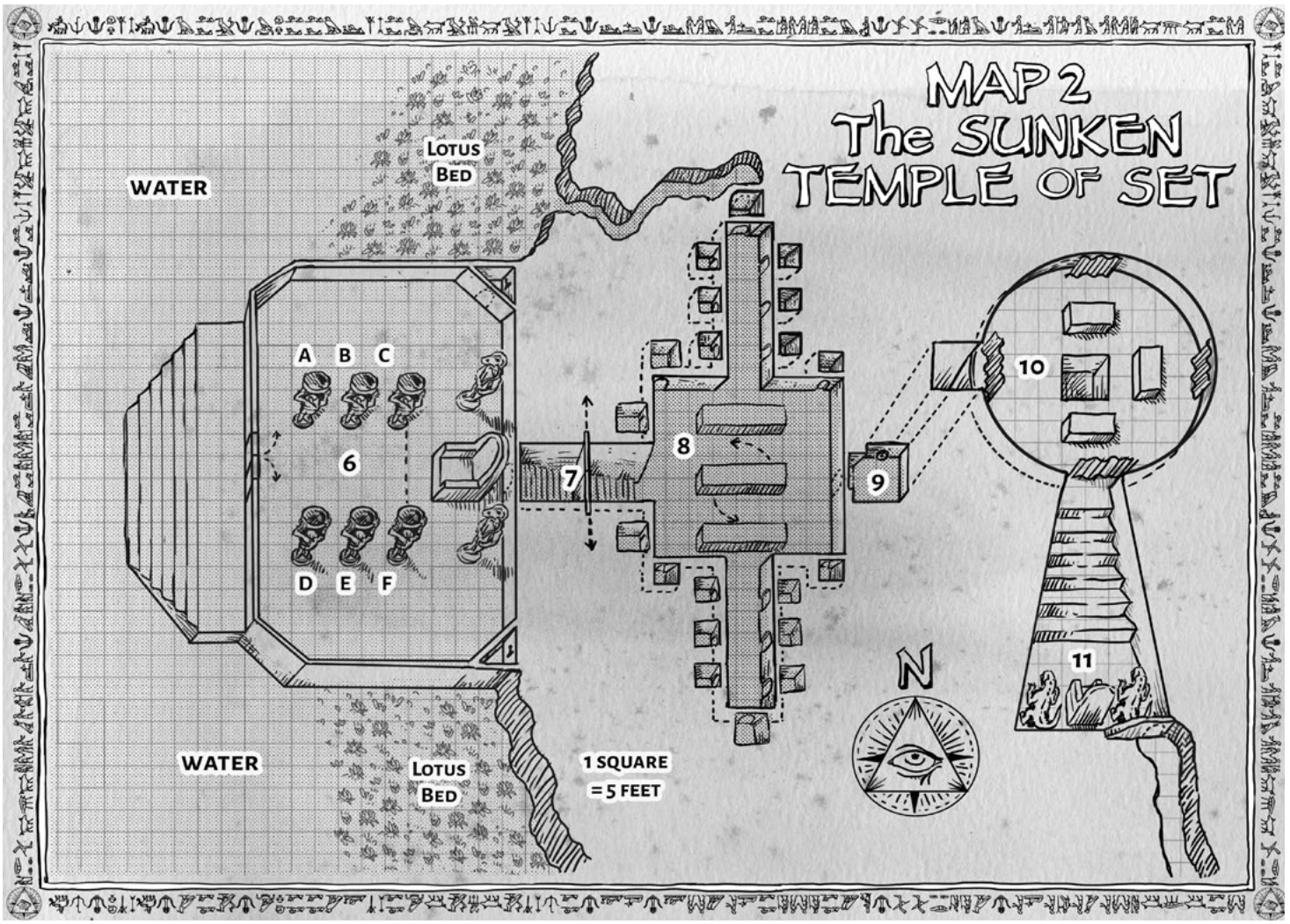
B. Humans

C. Hippopotamus

D. Camels

E. Jackals

F. Water Buffalos



Clinging to the upper 10 feet of pillar A is a **behir**, a crocodile-headed serpent-like monstrosity. A "gift" from Set to Makura, the creature has folded its legs along its sides and its natural coloration blends in well with the pillar. The behir can only be recognized as a living creature with a successful Wisdom (Perception) contest versus its Dexterity (Stealth). The behir waits to attack from behind, hopefully after some characters move to the other side of the *wall of force* and get split up. It starts its surprise attack with its lightning breath. Then while its breath attack recharges, it attacks with its bite, using its 10-foot reach to avoid melee while perched on the pillar. The creature fights to the death, charged with guarding this sacred chamber.

Throne. The throne is smooth stone, and features exquisite craftmanship with water motifs throughout and set with five symmetrical aquamarine gemstones. It radiates illusion magic. This throne is one of a set of enchanted devices with its counterpart being a similar throne in area 11. While a living creature sits on the throne in area 11, once per day it can cast a specialized *project image* to appear sitting in the throne in this chamber. The target in this chamber appears enlarged (to fit the oversized throne) and glows with either a brilliant radiance or a sinister shadowy pall. The user can speak (enhanced in a booming voice), gesture, and behave in other ways, although limited to seating. In this way, a high priest in area 11 could address a congregation or its minions in a deific manner.

The *project image* effect lasts for up to a day, assuming the one seated in area 11 maintains concentration. The sitter can also cast one spell through the *project image*, but this ends the connection between the thrones in one minute.

The aquamarine gemstones can be removed with a successful DC 15 Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) check and a sharp, pointed tool. Failure indicates the gemstone is ruined. The first such gemstone removed in this fashion releases a burst of arcane energy. All creatures within 15 feet

of the throne suffer 16 (3d10) force damage, although a successful DC 15 Intelligence saving throw reduces the damage by half. Each intact gemstone is worth 250 gp.

Statues. Each of the statues represent Sobek. Climbing a statue requires a successful DC 13 Strength (Athletics) check. Each statue sports hollowed eyes. These once held valuable emeralds now removed by Makura as each visage has been defaced with a sharp object. Each statue's arm that is held high can be swiveled at the elbow, bringing the khopesh perpendicular to its chest. Moving both of these arms (causing the moons to "descend") is required to open the secret door behind the throne.

At the base of each statue is the following passage (one line per base) concealed in the scrollwork. It requires a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) to notice them.

Only when both moons descend,
will the stone door ascend.

Secret Door. There is a 10-foot-wide stone slab blocking the exit of this chamber (to area 7). This secret door can be detected with a successful DC 13 Wisdom (Perception) check, but the slab weighs nearly a ton and can't be simply "opened". If both statue arms are rotated to their perpendicular position (both moons descend), the slab slowly opens. Its stone remains elevated until the lever in area 8 is pulled down.

Hidden Chambers. In the northeast and southeast corners of the room are hidden chambers. The secret doors concealing these chambers require a successful DC 17 Wisdom (Perception) check to locate. Each chamber is a nondescript triangular room with two items of note: a lever mounted on the east wall of each chamber and a closed stone chest. The stone chest to the north holds three bronze holy symbols (each worth 5 gp) dedicated to Sobek. The chest to the south holds a stash of four *potions of water breathing*.

Both levers are in the upright position. If both are pulled down, a loud grinding sound can be heard from down below, but nothing else seems to occur. This actually disables the trap in area 7.

Developments. Shortly after the characters enter the hall (but before the behir attacks and hopefully before they discover the *wall of force*), Rynchus uses the throne in his hybrid form to pose as Sobek. He threatens the characters and goads them, "You will never be able to defeat the master of this temple, one blessed by a god!". He commands the behir to attack and then casts *control water* in the room, flooding the chamber. The water level raises 5 feet per round (to a maximum of 20 feet), but then 6 rounds later, starts lowering the same amount. This ends the *project image* in 1 minute. (Rynchus cannot do this if he did not have time to retreat to area 11 after being encountered outside the temple in area 2.)

AREA 7 – THE WAY DOWN

The secret door to this descending corridor and stairs is detailed in area 6.

With the grinding sound of stone on stone, the huge slab raises up. A set of stairs descends into the murky depths of the water.

This corridor descends 30 feet into the sunken crypt and is completely underwater. The corridor is trapped. Unless the two levers in the hidden chambers in area 6 are moved to the lower position, the corridor is blocked by a metal wall. If touched, the wall discharges an electric shock, which causes 22 (4d10) lightning damage to all in the submerged corridor. A successful DC 15 Dexterity saving throw results in half damage. Once the trap is discharged, the walls can be pried open with a successful DC 18 Strength (Athletics) check to allow a Medium-sized creature to pass through, but something needs to hold the doors open or else they slide shut.

If both levers in area 6 are in the lower position, the metal walls have receded into the side walls and the trap is disabled.

AREA 8 – THE SUNKEN CRYPT

This entire chamber is underwater.

The steps descend into a crypt-like 40-foot square chamber with a 20-foot-high ceiling. The floor is set flagstones. Three enormous stone sarcophagi dominate the chamber, each 20 feet long and 5 feet wide. Aisles to the north and south apparently lead to burial crypts. At the corners of the room, stone slabs seal additional crypts. The opposite wall is covered with hieroglyphics and pictograms of religious ceremonies.

This chamber served as a crypt for the high priests and other worthy personages of the temple. The previous leaders of the temple left a few guardians.

Lever. An obvious lever in the upright position is affixed to the right-hand wall just inside the entrance to the crypt. If pulled down, it seals the secret door in area 6 and the metal doors in area 7. If pushed up, the door once again ascends.

Sealed Crypts. There are six crypts in the main chamber and another seven crypts in each the north and south corridors. Each crypt is sealed with a slab of stone plastered in place. It requires a successful DC 17 Strength (Athletics) check to open one of these crypts. If 10 minutes are spent chipping out the plaster, this check is at advantage. The contents of each crypt are random. Roll on the following table and if applicable any additional tables.

Table A – Crypt Contents

2d6	Result
2	Treasure (roll on table B)
3-4	Mummified human body
5-7	Mummified human body and treasure (roll on table B)
8-9	1d6 weapons (roll on table C)
10-11	Empty
12	Mummified crocodile and treasure (roll on table B with a +2 modifier)

Table B – Treasure

1d12	Treasure
1	1d4 x 100 bronze coins (worth 2 cp each)
2-4	1d4 weapons (roll on table C)
5-6	1d8 x 100 gp
7	3d4 x 10 pp
8	silver jeweled object (necklace, ring, bracer, anklet) worth 3d6 x 100 gp
9	gem-studded object (weapon, coffer, statuette, idol) worth 5d6 x 100 gp
10	gold jeweled object (statuette, necklace, ankh) worth 10d8 x 100 gp
11	platinum-gem studded object (statuette, scepter, crown) worth 1d4 x 1,000 gp
12+	Roll twice on this table

Table C – Weapons (50% chance ruined)

1d6	Weapon
1	Longbow
2	1d4 spears
3	Khopesh
4	Mace
5	Mace-axe
6	Roll twice on this table



The unsealed crypt at the end of the north passage is always empty. Concealed on the back wall is a secret door that can be located with a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check. It leads to a rough-hewn passage that turns west and then meanders about 80 feet, slowly climbing before exiting into the lake bottom below the lotus bed to the north of the temple. Rynchus is aware of this route and uses it to exit and enter the temple.

Sarcophagi. The three long sarcophagi are smooth, unadorned granite. The middle one is sealed with electrum. It takes 10 minutes to break the seal (yielding 85 ep worth of metal). Inside is a silver shield, emblazoned with a rearing lion in gold, resting on a stack of 12 gold bars (each worth 200 gp). This is *Mitra's Bulwark*, a Mitraic artifact (see below). This sarcophagus is set on a pivoting base which can be discerned with a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check. With relative ease, the entire sarcophagus can be rotated 90 degrees in a counterclockwise direction.

The other two sarcophagi are unsealed. Each contains a **giant crocodile zombie**. They are aroused if the opposite wall is investigated or their sarcophagi are opened. The giant crocodile zombies take one turn pushing the lid off and exiting the sarcophagi before moving to attack. The mindless undead fight until destroyed, but prominently displaying a holy symbol of Sobek wards off a direct attack.

Secret Door to the Shaft. The secret door on the east wall can be located with a successful DC 17 Wisdom (Perception) check. Examining the pictograms on the wall with a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check reveals the clue to opening the door nested above and below the arch of a pictogram of a letter "H" among the other hieroglyphics:

Three to one,
to get it done.

If the center sarcophagus is pivoted counterclockwise, it locks into place nearly adjoining the other two sarcophagi. This forms a letter "H", and unlocks the secret door, which lifts straight up, revealing area 9.

GIANT CROCODILE ZOMBIE (2)

Huge undead, lawful evil

AC: 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 85 (9d12 + 27)

Speed: 30 ft., swim 50 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
21 (+5)	9 (-1)	17 (+3)	2 (-4)	10 (+0)	7 (-2)

Saving Throws: Wis +3

Skills: Stealth +5

Damage Immunities: poison

Condition Immunities: poisoned

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages: —

Challenge: 5 (1,800 XP)

Undead Fortitude: If damage reduces the giant crocodile zombie to 0 hit points, it must make a Constitution saving throw with a DC of 5+ the damage taken, unless the damage is radiant or from a critical hit. On a success, the giant crocodile zombie drops to 1 hit point instead.

Undead Nature: The giant crocodile zombie doesn't require air, food, drink or sleep.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The giant crocodile zombie makes one bite and one tail attack.

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 21 (3d10 + 5) piercing damage plus 10 (3d6) necrotic damage and the target is grappled (escape DC 16). Until this grapple ends, the target is restrained, the giant crocodile zombie can't bite another target.

Tail: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 14 (2d8 + 5) bludgeoning damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 16 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

AREA 9 – THE SHAFT

The secret door effortlessly slides up, revealing a short 5-foot passage, terminating in a 10 foot plain square chamber. The worked walls are smooth and unadorned. Centered along the north wall is a bronze wheel.

This chamber is a shaft that extends 250 feet straight up. The water level is 30 feet high; above that is dry. The walls are smooth and it requires a successful DC 20 Strength (Athletics) check to scale. The floor of this chamber is actually a platform that can be raised and lowered to provide access to the area 10.

MITRA'S BULWARK

Armor (shield), unique (requires attunement)

Mitra's bulwark is an oval tower shield of bright metal adorned with a bas relief roaring lion's head on its outer surface. The Mitraic artifact functions as an *arrow-catching shield* in the hands of a good-aligned wielder.

The shield has 1 charge. While holding it, you can use an action and say a command phrase to transform the shield into a *wall of stone*. The *wall of stone* lasts for up to 10 minutes, although it can be ended sooner with another command phrase, which doesn't take an action. If all 10 panels of the wall are destroyed, the shield is likewise destroyed. The shield regains its charge daily at dawn.

If a wielder is attunded to a second Mitraic artifact, the shield as 2 charges. If the wielder is attuned to two other Mitriac artifacts, the shield has 3 charges.

Bronze Wheel. A large bronze wheel can be turned clockwise to raise the platform. This is a slow, laborious process that alerts any creatures in areas 10 and 11 of an impending arrival. Turning the wheel ascends the platform 10 feet per turn. A character that operates the wheel must make three DC 13 Constitution saving throws over the whole journey to area 10. If the character fails two or more of these saves, he gains a level of exhaustion. If one other character Helps with this task, the saving throws are made at advantage. Turning the wheel counterclockwise lowers the platform at double the rate and doesn't require saving throws.

AREA 10 – THE CHAMBER OF THE EXALTED ONE

The moving platform comes to a halt with a grinding protest of metal on stone. The air here is dry and warm. The back of a tapestry provides the only barrier to another room.

Once the tapestry is pulled aside, read the following:

Pulling the tapestry aside, you are greeted with soft illumina-

tion in a circular chamber. The ceiling is 30 feet overhead and dome shaped, but you can't see the source of the light. In the center of the room is a 10-foot square open pit. Surrounding the pit on three sides are plain stone altars soaked with crimson stains. You are entering the chamber from the west, and positioned at the three other points of a compass are similar tapestries.

This hard-to-reach chamber is reserved for the exalted ones stationed at the temple. It's also reserved for private sacrificial rituals and bloodletting ceremonies. Recently, Makura has taken primary residence in this chamber, preferring to allow Rynchus to serve his every whim, such as bringing in the occasional sentient being for sacrifice and consumption. This setup serves Rynchus well as he plots behind his master's back. Ambient light is provided via several *continual flame* spells placed on wall tiles.

Tapestries. There are four tapestries hanging about the room. Each has a base color of red with gold thread and are decorated with foul prayers, fables told via hieroglyphics, and pictograms of evil acts involving sacrifice on altars. Although each tapestry has a malevolent theme, each is worth 700 gp.

Altars. The three short altars are similar and all bear crimson stains. The east altar has a secret compartment that can be detected with a successful DC 20 Intelligence (Investigation) check. Inside are an array of torture implements and sacrificial daggers, all with carved ivory handles. The lot is 17 pieces and worth 1700 gp. There is also a platinum bowl wrought as a coiled serpent (worth 650 gp). Between the north and east altars along the wall is a pile of 22 torches (for use in casting *sticks to snakes*).

Sacrificial Pit. The pit is 15 feet deep and stained with the blood of countless victims. At the bottom of the pit is Makura's accumulated wealth since settling in at the temple. It includes 1,667 gp, 39 pp, an ivory scroll tube shaped like a bone, set with onyx (worth 250 gp) holding a pair of magic scrolls (one is a *spell scroll* with *enhance ability* and the other is a *scroll of protection from fiends*), a *+1 shortsword,* and a teak coffer inlaid with silver (worth 475 gp) holding an assortment of gems. The collection of gemstones includes four pieces of jet (worth 100 gp each, six brown-green garnets (worth 100 gp each), a blue spinel (worth 500 gp), four large round emeralds (each worth 1,000 gp), a pale gray topaz (worth 1,500 gp) and a flawed black sapphire (worth 3,000 gp), and a dusty rose prism *ioun stone* (protection). The emeralds were extracted from the eye sockets of the statues in area 6 as Makura defaced them.

DIVINE ASSISTANCE?

During the confrontation with Makura, Rynchus uses his *ring of messaging* to deliver the following whispered assistance to a character: "The foul fiend's True Name is Makura! Utter it aloud with conviction to help lay him low!"

Makura. This lesser Son of Set has the lower body of a thick serpent, the torso of a muscular human with two arms, and three snake-like necks, each ending in a crocodilian head that sports wicked curved horns and piercing yellow eyes. The covetous Makura spends most of his time wallowing in his meager hoard at the bottom of the sacrificial pit, plotting against the other Chosen Sons.

Assuming the characters use the elevator in area 9, he is well aware of their arrival. He starts by casting *sticks to snakes*, and then he summons 1d6 **minions of Set** (the GM can select the number of minions to help balance the combat to the characters). The minions appear behind the other three tapestries and step out to engage the characters. They move into position to attempt to shove targets into the pit. Once the minions are destroyed, Makura casts *conjure animals* (summoning 16 **giant poisonous snakes** that drop from the heavens) and then he pulls his massive bulk out of the pit. He attacks with his great mace-axe and all three heads.

Developments. Makura did not suffer humiliation for the past year to be defeated by some upstart heroes. If reduced to 20 or fewer hit points, he ceases attacking and offers a truce. He claims he can restore any characters turned to stone (he can't), and offers a *Mitraic artifact* in exchange for his life. Rynchus, aware of the confrontation from his throne in area 11 will have none of this. He casts *flame strike* centered on Makura, hopefully catching one of more characters in its area of effect. Since the lesser son doesn't have resistance to fire or radiant damage, and this negates his regeneration for one turn, he likely dies in the divine conflagration.

MAKURA, LESSER SON OF SET

Large fiend (demon), chaotic evil

AC: 20 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 127 (15d10 + 45)

Speed: 30 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	17 (+3)	17 (+3)	15 (+2)	12 (+1)	8 (-1)

Saving Throws: Con +7, Int +6, Wis +5

Damage Resistances: acid, lightning, poison

Damage Immunities: bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical weapons

Condition Immunities: poisoned

Senses: darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages: Abyssal, Common, telepathy 100 ft.

Challenge: 9 (5,000 XP)

Innate Spellcasting: Makura's spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 14). He can cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

- 1/day each: *snake charm, sticks to snakes, conjure animals* (snakes only; using a 5th level spell slot)

Limited Magic Immunity: Makura is immune to spells of 3rd level or lower unless he wishes to be affected.

Magic Resistance: Makura has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Regeneration: Makura regains 5 hit points at the start of his turn. If he takes fire or radiant damage, this trait doesn't function at the start of his next turn. He only dies if it starts its turn at 0 hit points and doesn't regenerate.

True Name: Each Lesser Son has a true name that can be discovered or divined. If the true name is spoken and the Lesser Son of Set can hear it, it loses its Magic Resistance trait and all its saving throws are at disadvantage for 1 hour.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: Makura makes three petrifying bite attacks and one attack with his mace-axe. In place of his mace-axe attack, he can constrict a grappled target or make two slam attacks.

Petrifying Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 9 (1d10 + 4) piercing damage and the target is grappled (escape DC 14). While grappled, the target is restrained. If the target is a creature, it must succeed a DC 13 Constitution Saving throw against being magically petrified. On a failed save, the creature begins to turn to stone and is restrained. It must repeat the saving throw at the end of its next turn. On a success, the effect ends. On a failure, the creature is petrified for 24 hours.

Mace-Axe: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 11 (2d6 + 4) slashing damage and 7 (2d6) bludgeoning damage.

Constrict: One target that Makura has grappled takes 17 (2d12 + 4) bludgeoning damage.

Slam: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 11 (2d6 + 4) bludgeoning damage.

Summon Minions of Set (1/Day): Makura may summon 1d6 minions of Set. They appear in unoccupied spaces within 60 feet of the Lesser Son and act as allies. They remain for 1 minute or until the Lesser Son is killed or they are dismissed with an action.

MINION OF SET

Medium fiend (demon, shapechanger), chaotic evil

AC: 20 (plate armor and shield)

Hit Points: 55 (10d8 + 10)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)

Damage Resistance: acid, cold, fire

Damage Immunities: lightning, poison, psychic

Condition Immunities: frightened, poisoned

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages: Abyssal, Common

Challenge: 4 (1,100 XP)

Dueling: When wielding a weapon in one hand and no other weapons, a minion of Set gets +2 to damage rolls with that weapon.

Improved Critical: A minion of Set scores a critical hit on a 19-20.

Magic Resistance: The minion of Set has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Shapechange (1/Day): A minion of Set can use its action to polymorph into a **giant constrictor snake** or a **giant poisonous snake**. It can revert to its true form as

an action. It takes on the statistics of the creature as if using the spell *polymorph*. It reverts to its true form if it dies.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The minion of Set makes two khopesh attacks.

Khopesh: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 10 (1d8 + 5) slashing damage. The minion can forgo dealing damage to instead force the target to make a DC 13 Strength saving throw or drop its weapon or shield (minion of Set's choice).

REACTIONS

Cleave: If a minion of Set reduces a target to 0 or fewer hit points, it can use its reaction to make another attack on a different target within 5 feet of it.

This twisted fiendish humanoid has scales covering its serpentine face. It wears bronze plate armor and carries a shield emblazoned with a coiled cobra about to strike.

AREA 11 – THE AUDIENCE CHAMBER

When the characters pull back this tapestry (even if still engaged with Makura) read the following:

Beyond the southern *tapestry is another chamber, triangular in shape and sloping up toward the opposite end. Only 10 feet wide at the entrance, the far end of the room is 25 feet wide and 50 feet higher than where you stand. A series of 5-foot-high steps lead to the opposite end of the chamber, and the walls are covered with pictograms and hieroglyphics depicting crocodile-headed humanoids enslaving a human population. At the far end of the room is a massive stone throne, similar in size and design as the one in the main temple below. Flanking the throne are statues of crocodiles, heads thrown back, toothy maws agape.*

Sitting on the oversized perch is a hybrid humanoid; a cross between a crocodile and a human. He wears a crimson cloak with black edges and a wooden rod rests on his lap.

This is an audience chamber used by the high priest to engage with his close attendants in person, but also engage with his faithful in area 6 via the throne. The ceiling slants upward as the elevation of the room increases to the south, maintaining a 20-foot-high reach. The hieroglyphics are fanciful decorations with prayers to Sobek, portents to when "the great one will walk among the mortals", and various diatribes against agents of good.

NEW SPELLS

SNAKE CHARM

1st-level enchantment

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 60 feet

Components: V, S

Duration: Concentration, up to 1 minute

By swaying your holy symbol and your whole body, you can create a hypnotic effect that charms snakes. All snakes within range must make a successful Wisdom saving throw or become charmed for the duration. While charmed, the snakes are incapacitated and have a speed of 0. If the snakes were aggressive (i.e., attacking) when this spell is cast, or they are giant varieties of snakes, their saving throw is made at advantage.

STICKS TO SNAKES

2nd-level transmutation

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 120 feet

Components: V, S, M (one stick, such as a torch, per snake)

Duration: Concentration, up to 10 minutes

This spell transforms up to eight normal sticks (at least 1 foot long, with a diameter of ½ inch) to constrictor snakes (with maximum hit points). Roll a d20 for each snake; on an 11 or higher it is a poisonous snake (also with maximum hit points) instead. The snakes are friendly to you and your allies and can be commanded to attack or perform simple duties. At the end of the duration, the snakes turn back into mundane sticks.

At Higher Levels. When you cast this spell using a spell slot higher than 3rd level, you can create two additional snakes for each slot level above 3rd level.

Stone Steps. Six 5-foot-high stone steps lead to the opposite end of the room. No skill check is required to climb these, but each requires 10 feet of movement to scale.

Throne. The throne is smooth stone set with five symmetrical aquamarine gemstones and features exquisite craftmanship with water motifs throughout. It radiates illusion magic. This throne is one of a pair of enchanted devices, with its counterpart being a similar throne in



area 6. While a living creature sits on the throne here, once per day it can cast a specialized *project image*, to appear sitting in the throne in area 6 among a wash of deific enhancements. See the description in that area.

The aquamarine gemstones can be removed with a successful DC 15 Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) check and a sharp, pointed tool. Failure indicates the gemstone is ruined. The first such gemstone removed in this fashion releases a burst of arcane energy. All creatures within 15 feet of the throne suffer 16 (3d10) force damage, although a successful DC 15 Intelligence saving throw reduces the damage by half. Each intact gemstone is worth 250 gp.

The High Priest. Rynchus, a werecrocodile high priest, sits on his throne, a master of none. He commands the characters to stop on the first or second step while he addresses them. He thanks them for defeating the "abomination and self-appointed ruler of this holy sanctuary". For their troubles, he grants them the treasure in area 10, and encourages them to depart this sacred place in haste or face the wrath of Sobek himself. He is haughty, proud, and over-confident. He enjoys mocking the characters and their pathetic abilities.

If the characters attack, Rynchus reveals a scroll under his cloak and casts *blade barrier*. He then uses *spiritual weapon* (macana), *flame strike*, *guiding bolt* (possibly cast using a higher spell slot), or *blindness/deafness* on suitable targets. If a target moves into melee range, he uses *inflict wounds* or his enchanted rod. Once most of the characters are through the barrier, he casts *animate objects* on the two statues (each is a Large target) or *insect plague* as conditions warrant. If reduced to 20 or fewer hit points, he uses his magic cape to *dimension door* into the secret corridor and flees the temple.

Secret Passage. In the southeast corner of the room is a secret door that can be located with a successful DC 17 Wisdom (Perception) check. The door can only be opened if the crocodile statue in front of it is turned clockwise a one-quarter turn. The swiveling nature of the statue base can be discovered with a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check or simply with trial and error.

Beyond is a 5-foot-wide passage that winds around while sloping up. After nearly 500 feet, it finally terminates at a boulder covering the exit onto the plateau above the canyon. It requires a successful DC 22 Strength (Athletics) to move the boulder enough to squeeze by. Rynchus uses *stone shape* to bypass the boulder if he uses this route to escape.

SOBEK INTERVENES

Rynchus is a 10th level cleric, and he can spend an action to seek divine intervention from Sobek. This has a 10% chance of being granted. A suitable effect would be that of an *earthquake* spell centered in this chamber. The radius is enough to divert the river nearby to start flooding the upper chambers while collapsing the temple. Rynchus then makes his escape with his cape.

RYNCHUS, WERECROCODILE HIGH PRIEST

Medium humanoid (human, shapechanger), neutral evil

AC: 14 (breastplate) in humanoid or hybrid form, 12 (natural armor) in crocodile form

Hit Points: 65 (10d8 + 20)

Speed: 30 ft. (swim 30 ft. in crocodile form)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	17 (+3)	9 (-1)

Saving Throws: Int +4, Wis +7

Skills: Stealth +3

Damage Immunities: bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical weapons that aren't silvered

Senses: passive Perception 13

Languages: Common (can't speak in crocodile form)

Challenge: 6 (2,900 XP)

Special Equipment: *spell scroll (blade barrier), spell scroll (insect plague), cape of the mountebank, rod of the crocodile, ring of messaging*, bronze holy symbol (Sobek), gold headdress set with onyx (worth 1,250 gp).

Hold Breath (Hybrid or Crocodile Form Only): The werecrocodile can hold its breath for 15 minutes.

Shapechanger: The werecrocodile can use its action to polymorph into a Medium-sized crocodile-human hybrid, into a Large-sized crocodile, or back into its true form, which is humanoid. Its statistics, other than its size, speed, and AC, are the same in each form. Any equipment it is wearing or carrying isn't transformed. It reverts to its true form if it dies.

Spellcasting: Rynchus is a 10th level spellcaster. His spellcasting ability is Wisdom (save DC 14, +6 to hit with spell attacks). He has the following cleric spells prepared:

Cantrips (at will): *guidance, light, resistance, sacred flame, spare the dying*

1st level (4 slots): *command, guiding bolt, inflict wounds, shield of faith*

2nd level (3 slots): *blindness/deafness, hold person, spiritual weapon*

3rd level (3 slots): *bestow curse, water walk*

4th level (3 slots): *control water, stone shape*

5th level (2 slots): *animate objects, flame strike*

ACTIONS

Multiattack (Humanoid or Hybrid Form Only): In humanoid form, the werecrocodile can make two macana attacks. In hybrid form, it can make two attacks, only one of which can be a bite.

Macana (Humanoid or Hybrid Form Only): *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) slashing damage.

Bite (Crocodile or Hybrid Form Only): *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d10 + 2) piercing damage, and the target is grappled (escape DC 12). Until the grapple ends, the target is restrained, and the werecrocodile can't bite another target. If the target is a humanoid, it must succeed a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or be cursed with werecrocodile lycanthropy. This saving throw must be repeated for each turn the target is grappled.

New Magic Items

ROD OF THE CROCODILE

Rod, rare (requires attunement by a cleric or druid)

This rod is a wooden shaft wrapped in cured crocodile skin. The head is iron and shaped like a crocodile. This functions as a magical mace-axe that grants a +1 bonus to hit and damage.

You can use a bonus action to speak this rod's command word and make the head of the rod transform into an animated crocodile head for 1 minute. By using another bonus action to speak the command word again, you return the rod to its normal form.

You can make a melee attack using the crocodile head, which has a reach of 5 ft. Your proficiency bonus applies to the attack roll. On a hit, the target takes 1d10 +1 piercing damage and the target is grappled (escape DC 12). Until this grapple ends, the target is restrained, and the rod can't be used to attack another target.

The crocodile head can be attacked while it is animated. It has an Armor Class of 14 and has 25 hit points. If the head drops to 0 hit points, the rod is destroyed. As long as it's not destroyed, the rod regains all lost hit points when it reverts to its inanimate form.

RING OF MESSAGING

Ring, uncommon (requires attunement by a spellcaster)

This is a plain ring of twisted copper wire has 3charges. As an action, the wearer can expend a charge to cast the cantrip *message*. All 3 charges return daily at dawn.

Concluding the Adventure

The defeat of Makura deals another blow to Set and his allies controlling the region. It's also possible the characters have recovered another *Mitraic artifact* in their defiance to Set. If this adventure is being used in conjunction with *Dark Tower*, Rynchus could offer information on the location of a hidden tomb (located in the Valley of Tombs) that holds the secret names of one (or more) of the Chosen Sons of Set. Such information would be valuable during a confrontation.

Of course, it's very likely that Rynchus escapes the clutches of the characters and becomes a reoccurring antagonist. Unless the temple was destroyed by the wrath of Sobek, he eventually returns and sets up a base of operations. Soon after, he begins to attract the attention of cultists and worshipers. The GM should determine what his ultimate objective is, but eventually he will clash with the characters again.



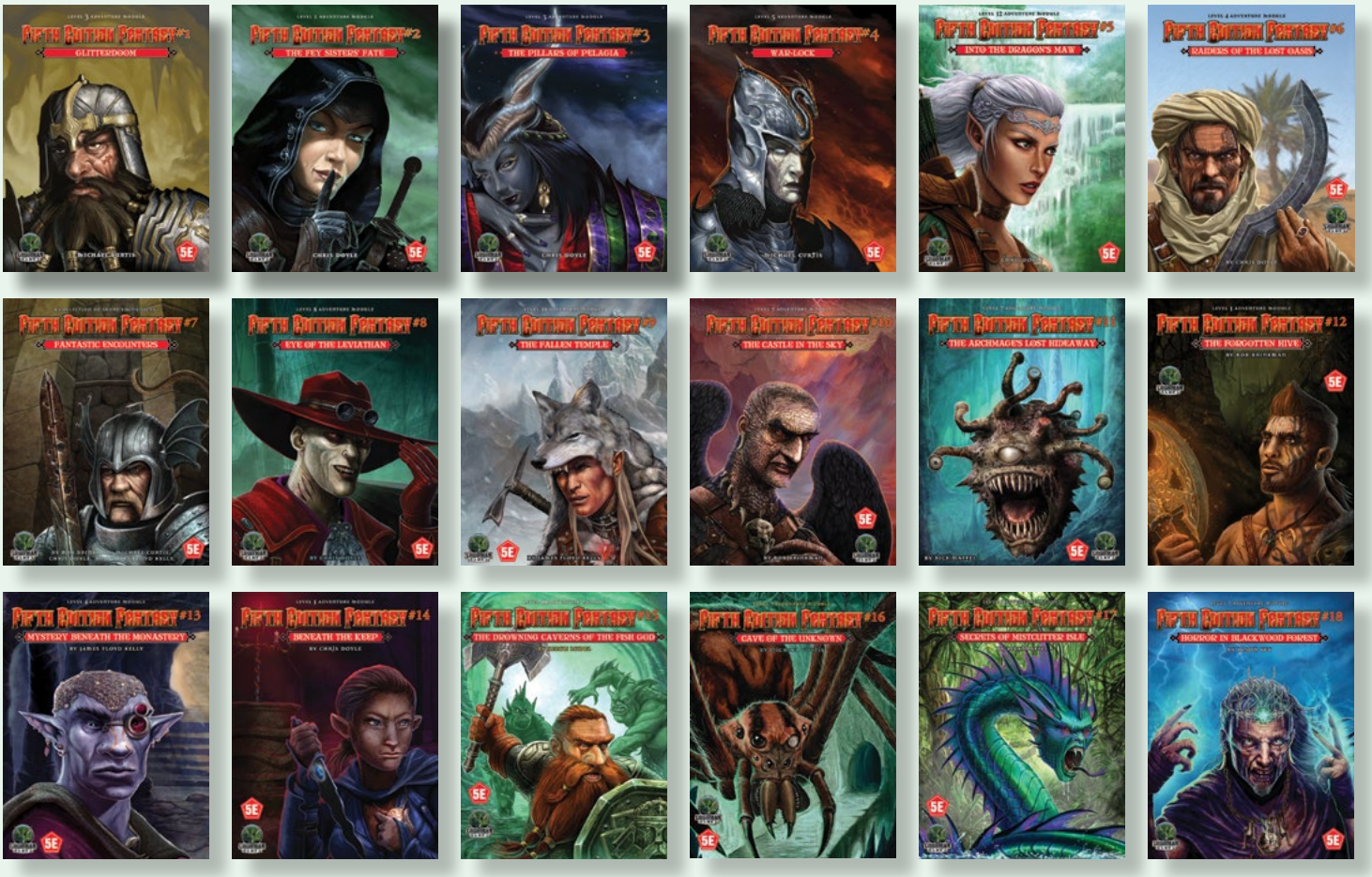
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Left: The original sketch cover submitted by Sanjulian for this Free RPG Day 2021 adventure.

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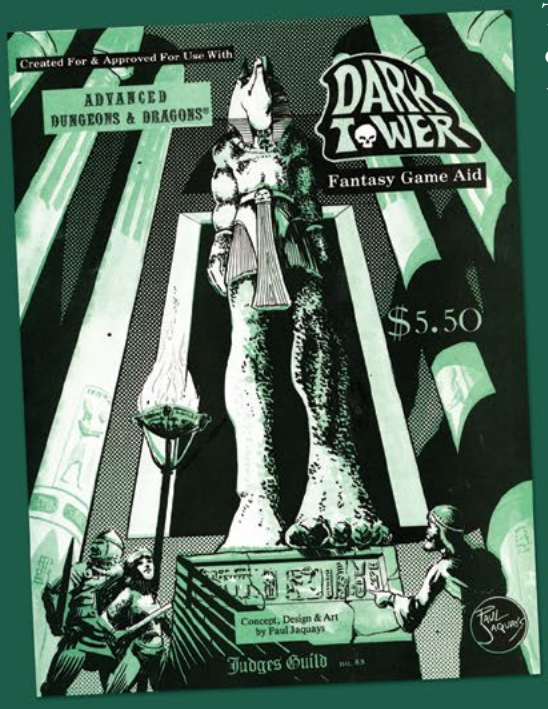


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